

meals while traveling) for a long-distance job search. Items like clothes and shoes for interviews are not deductible.

- » *Work-related educational expenses.* If you take a course that helps you maintain or improve the skills you use to perform your current job, you may be able to deduct your expenses. Also, if a course is required either by your employer or by law in order for you to keep your job (and, of course, the company doesn't cover the tuition), you may be able to deduct its cost. But if you take a course to help train you for a new line of work or that enables you to meet the minimum educational requirements of your profession, you can't deduct the tuition. So a financial analyst taking a cooking course can't deduct the cost of the class, and a paralegal can't deduct the tuition costs of law school. But a teacher who takes a course to learn how to operate new technology in the classroom may be able to deduct tuition expenses.
- » *Mandatory uniforms for work.* Suits and ties aren't deductible, but nurses' uniforms, firefighter uniforms, postal uniforms, safety shoes and glasses, hard hats, and work gloves are. (If you're a computer programmer who wears a hard hat to work for kicks, it doesn't count.) If your employer reimburses you for these expenses, you can't deduct them.
- » *Unreimbursed business travel and entertainment expenses.* If you pay these costs yourself, there are very specific rules about how much you're allowed to deduct. In general, you must keep a detailed log of your trips and be prepared to prove the business purpose of each expense.